

Different by Design

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The typefaces used in this poster for the text 'different by design' are created by the following designers:

Peridot PE Variable - Pria Ravichandran
Omnes greek - Toshi Omagari
Zubtrak Stencil - Vaibhav Singh
Meursault VF - Kalapi Gajjar
Jali Latin Variable - Mohamad Dakak
Duke Variable - Hidetaka Yamasaki
AwanZaman - Juliet Shen
JAF Johannes - Shoko Mugikura
Abacaxi Latin VF - Kalapi Gajjar
Dongle - Yanghee Ryu

The struggles of inclusivity in the arts education system

This zine explores how in places of education, the topic of inclusivity is heavily discussed and debated. Especially in the arts sector. One of the amazing things about the creative industry is the freedom of self expression. However, statistics shown here emphasise the lack of representation with the industry.

Minorities in arts education often face barriers that many other students don't. Understanding the root of these problems is an important step to challenge the system within educational spaces as creative minorities continue to bring vital perspectives and highlight the need for meaningful inclusion.

30% 2.7%

30% of disabled students report facing significant barriers to accessing arts education.

In the UK art sector only 2.7% of the workforce are from a "Black, Asian or ethnically diverse" background.

Student experiences

For this issue the DBD team created a form to gather anonymous opinions. Here highlights experiences and ongoing challenges from queer students in the Art, Film, and Design departments at the University of Reading:

"I definitely still experience struggles regarding my sexuality and trying to find communities. It's daunting having to tell people in order to potentially find somebody else like you, you never know what reaction you'll get."

"I think there's still an essence of internalised homophobia within the LGBT+ community that a lot of people don't talk about, such as appearing 'too gay' or 'too straight'. It's definitely hard to find others without being in the LGBT+ society, and it's difficult to talk to others in the community without already being friends with them."

Inclusion in the University

Looking at the experiences students shared there still is a long way to go in trying to attain full inclusivity. Many stigmas still exist both within the community itself and across the University of Reading as a whole. However, there have been steps taken to break down barriers to allow for more inclusive opportunities and educational resources. One example is the Design Discourse module within the BA Graphic Communication course, degree students were collectively able to choose a topic to research. The chosen theme was, 'Design Queeries and Feminist Theories'. This allowed students to explore the struggles faced by queer designers in the industry while also celebrating their inspiring work and impact on the design community.

Inclusivity in the curriculum

Another way in which the BA Graphic Communication course considered inclusivity was by adding inclusive design as part of the second year curriculum. Within the User Experience module, students are tasked with researching inclusive features when creating an app. Thinking about requirements such visual impairments, dyslexia, autism and ADHD, hard of hearing, and motor disabilities. This helps students to understand the importance of meeting accessibility requirements so that everyone's needs are met and so that people with disabilities have an easier and more comfortable user experience.

Celebrating work by graduates of colour

The poster on the reverse celebrates typefaces designed by people of colour who have graduated from the Department of Typography & Graphic Communication. It highlights the talent and creative range within this community, while honouring how each designer's culture is expressed through their work, as several of the selected typefaces support other language scripts.



Scan the QR code to follow the guide on the do's and don'ts on designing for accessibility

References: <https://shorturl.at/YZcqH>
<https://shorturl.at/y5qqE>



'I am, we are ... different by design' is an annual student-led zine published by the Department of Typography & Graphic Communication at the University of Reading. This year, the zine was curated, collated and designed by Eleanor Denton, Aurelien Flatman, Grace Johnson, and Jess Scrivener.

This year's edition focuses on four themes: mental health, menstrual health, community & inclusion, and student finances. These were the most commonly raised issues that students in the School of Arts and Communication Design highlighted to us in a survey.

In the University's 100th year, we have brought together and presented under-represented student voices from across the School.

Design by Grace Johnson